

Dear Admissions Committee,

RE: RECOMMENDATION FOR ROBERT OTIENO ADMISSION NUMBER 12458

It is with great honor that I recommend Otieno Robert for admission into your institution. I have been a guidance counselor at Kapsabet Boys High School. It is in this capacity that I knew Robert while he schooled here. Robert joined our institution under a rigorous competitive admission process, managing to stand out among the ninety thousand students who sought admission into the school. When Robert finished his grade twelve studies, he excelled in his academics. Due to his outstanding GPA, exemplary extracurricular profile, leadership pursuits and community engagement, Robert was among our overall Valedictorians.

Robert was a philomath, exhibiting a high aptitude for Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics. Robert was interested in understanding the functionality of the universe and all its components through the realm of applied physics. It is this interest that made Robert continuously participate in the Kenya Science and Engineering Fair. In his final year, Robert attempted to address the nation's locust saga. He designed a drone which had an electric wire mesh, and using the concept of heat through a conductor, he drew hypotheses that if the drone flew in opposite directions to swarms of locusts, heat from the mesh would roast them as they dropped on farms. Farmers would later harvest them for consumption. His project won him accolades, managing to be the top agricultural project in the sub county, county and regional levels. However, due to COVID-19, the project's journey to the nationals was short lived. Robert nonetheless grew fond and became an apt grassroot entrepreneur in solving farmers' broken equipment in rural areas during the lockdown period. Robert was also among the first students in the history of our institution to participate in Lego Robotics. Though a new challenge, he constantly pushed himself to understand the concepts behind a good robotic system. Through the experience, he participated in Princeton's Professor Naomi Leonard's TED talk on flock logic, in a bid to understand more on opinion dynamics in robotic systems. His efforts in the field of robotics intrigued Team Kenya Robotics, who have appointed him a mentor for Team Kenya Robotics 2022-2023 that will represent the country in Switzerland. Your institution's track record of availing students with robotic equipment and renowned faculty will assist him further his outlook on Kenya's robotic sphere.

Robert was the most outspoken student of his class. He was always confident in airing his views to those he engaged with. Whether it was at the debate club, class and house meeting or the school assembly, he raised concerns on important issues affecting the school. The most notable, however, was marshalling his class to be an exemption in the school by becoming the first class in the history of our institution to top the nation. On one Thursday morning during a meeting with the form principal, Robert spoke passionately about the significance of names and whether or not his peers wanted their names to have remembrance. The veracity of his arguments that the class should stop focusing on the past or the future, and only attack ruthlessly the present in my opinion helped the class to elope as the top class in Kenya. It is his outspoken nature that made him selected as a junior to join the debate club which previously comprised only seniors. Here, Robert's role in the team as a third speaker was to finalise the team's arguments, dotting the i's and crossing the f's. While most debaters defended their arguments like they were in a courtroom, Robert took a contrarian approach. He had the courage to embrace the truths of the opposing side before he went on to formulate his own arguments. His most iconic moment was quoting Biblical Joshua's quote '*Choose ye*

today' when summarising his arguments, leaving the audience and judges to ponder over what he had just said. He excelled as a debater, as their debate team won the Rift Valley region and national edition of the Great Debaters Contest. This was such a great feat for our institution, which had never stepped on the national debate podium for a while. On an individual note, Robert was honored as the fifth best male debater and second best researcher. I am sure Robert's outspoken nature and openness will serve him in your institution's quest for truth.

As he grew from the Kapsabet Boys High School community, Robert ensured he gave back to the Kapsabet community. Due to his excellent mastery of poetry, Robert wrote poetic verses for our Poetry Club, which they performed at the Kenya Music Festivals. His most outstanding verse was 'The Big 4 Agenda', which sought to champion affordable housing, universal healthcare, food security and efficient manufacturing in tune with the country's vision 2030. The agenda really mattered to him as during his younger years, Robert's family first lived in Manyatta slums and the living conditions were pathetic. Of all the agendas therefore, he was really connected to affordable housing due to his earlier experiences in the slums. The verse was the best in the sub county and county levels. In the regional level, it took third runner up slot, failing by a spot to make it to the nationals. Each class of twelfth graders in our institution are required to come up with a name and chant that unifies them in their final academic journey. Robert's class was called Praetors and their mission was to become the top school in the country, a feat the school effortlessly worked towards. The chant would motivate them for the task ahead. Robert did not back down from this opportunity to showcase his prose skills. Using local cultural battle diction like '*mundu khu mundu*' (man to man) and rhythmic lines such as '*we set the course, we are the pace*', he added a taste of patriotism to the chant, making his peers feel inspired when chanting it during their class assemblies. Whenever they performed, I noticed the passion it gave them in actualising their vision. When the national results were released, the school attained its first ever position one nationally. As the chant reiterated, the class did set the course, they were indeed the pace and won the race. His input in writing the chant had a great impact on his lot and the school community as a whole.

Robert has my utmost recommendation to your institution. His aptitude for STEM programs, outspoken nature and community-consciousness lead me to believe your institution is the right place for him for intellectual elevation and strengthening of character. I have no doubt he will benefit from you as you will from his presence at your institution.

Yours sincerely,

Fred Odinga

Head of Department- Guidance and Counselling.